SECURITY OPERATIONS CENTER

Phishing Email Investigation Report

Greenholt PLC — Suspicious Financial Transfer Email

FINAL VERDICT	TRUE POSITIVE — MALICIOUS PHISHING / BEC ATTEMPT

Analyst	Alen Sales K S
Incident	Phishing / Business Email Compromise
Severity	High
Environment	Controlled Security Lab
Disposition	Escalate for containment and endpoint investigation if attachment was accessed

Executive assessment: The message contains multiple independent phishing indicators, including an unexpected financial-transfer theme, sender/Reply-To inconsistency, suspicious originating infrastructure, and a deceptive attachment whose actual type was identified as a RAR archive.

Prepared as a concise enterprise-style SOC case report. Observed facts are separated from potential downstream impact; endpoint compromise is not claimed unless supported by endpoint telemetry.

1. Incident Overview

A Greenholt PLC sales executive reported an unexpected message apparently associated with a known customer. The employee identified a generic greeting, an unexpected money-transfer context, an unsolicited attachment, and communication inconsistent with the customer's normal style.

The SOC performed email triage, raw-header analysis, infrastructure investigation, SPF/DMARC review, and attachment analysis to determine authenticity and risk.

2. Key Findings

Finding	Assessment
Financial-transfer social engineering	High risk — message context can create urgency and influence payment-related decisions.
Sender / Reply-To mismatch	High risk — replies are directed to a different domain than the visible sender.
Originating IP	192.119.71.157; infrastructure attribution should be documented with lookup date/source.
Attachment	SWT_#09674321___PDF__.CAB
SHA256	2e91c533615a9bb8929ac4bb76707b2444597ce063d84a4b33525e25074fff3f
File size / actual type	400.26 KB / RAR archive

3. Email Artifacts

Artifact	Value
Transfer Reference	09674321
Display Name	Mr. James Jackson
Sender	info@mutawamarine.com
Reply-To	info.mutawamarine@mail.com
Return-Path Domain	mutawamarine.com
Originating IP	192.119.71.157
Attachment	SWT_#09674321___PDF__.CAB

4. Header & Authentication Analysis

Reply-To: The visible sender is info@mutawamarine.com, while the Reply-To address is info.mutawamarine@mail.com. This mismatch is a significant authenticity concern, particularly in a financial context.

SPF: v=spf1 include:spf.protection.outlook.com -all. SPF identifies authorized sending infrastructure but does not independently establish that a specific message is legitimate.

DMARC: v=DMARC1; p=quarantine; fo=1. The published policy requests quarantine treatment for applicable authentication/alignment failures. Authentication controls must still be correlated with message headers and content.

5. Attachment Analysis

The attachment filename was SWT_#09674321___PDF__.CAB. The name is designed to look document-related, but technical analysis identified the actual file type as a RAR archive. This file-type mismatch is a significant phishing indicator.

SHA256	2e91c533615a9bb8929ac4bb76707b2444597ce063d84a4b33525e25074fff3f
Size	400.26 KB
Actual Type	RAR archive

6. Indicators of Compromise

Type	Indicator
IP	192.119.71.157
Sender	info@mutawamarine.com
Reply-To	info.mutawamarine@mail.com
Domain	mutawamarine.com
Filename	SWT_#09674321___PDF__.CAB
SHA256	2e91c533615a9bb8929ac4bb76707b2444597ce063d84a4b33525e25074fff3f

7. Attack Assessment

The evidence supports a phishing/BEC delivery attempt. The attacker appears to use financial context to establish urgency and an unsolicited archive to increase the likelihood of user interaction. The deceptive filename and actual RAR file type indicate an attempt to disguise the attachment's nature.

Potential downstream outcomes include malware execution, credential compromise, or payment fraud. These outcomes remain potential unless confirmed by endpoint, identity, or financial-system telemetry.

8. MITRE ATT&CK; Mapping

Technique	Observed relevance
T1566 — Phishing	Email used as suspected initial delivery mechanism.
T1566.001 — Spearphishing Attachment	Suspicious attachment delivered through email.
T1036 — Masquerading	Attachment presentation attempts to disguise its nature.

9. Recommended SOC Actions

• Quarantine the original email and prevent further delivery where supported.

• Search the environment for the sender, Reply-To address, originating IP, filename, and SHA256.

• Identify all recipients of the same or related message.

• Determine whether the attachment was downloaded, opened, extracted, or executed.

• If accessed, investigate endpoint process, file, PowerShell, persistence, DNS, and outbound network telemetry.

• Verify whether any financial action was initiated and independently validate payment instructions.

• Reset potentially compromised credentials when supported by evidence.

10. Final Analyst Assessment

Classification: TRUE POSITIVE — MALICIOUS PHISHING / BEC ATTEMPT

Severity: HIGH

Disposition: Escalate for containment, threat hunting, and endpoint investigation if user interaction occurred.

Analyst: Alen Sales K S

Investigated, analyzed, reported, and documented by Alen Sales K S.

This case demonstrates an end-to-end SOC phishing investigation: triage → header analysis → infrastructure validation → SPF/DMARC review → attachment analysis → hashing → IOC extraction → risk assessment → remediation.

END OF REPORT